PROJECT PROPOSAL

DESIGN AND DEVELOPMENT OF AN INFORMATIVE WEBSITE FOR THE DANGOTE EAST AFRICA PETROLEUM REFINERY PROJECT IN KENYA

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1. BACKGROUND

•The Dangote East Africa Petroleum Refinery is a major industrial project being developed in Lamu County, Kenya, officially launched through a groundbreaking ceremony in September 2026.
•The facility is planned to have a crude oil processing capacity of approximately 700,000 barrels per day, alongside integrated facilities including a power plant and chemical manufacturing units.
•The refinery is located within the LAPSSET Special Economic Zone at the Ruiru Bypass/Lamu corridor to enhance regional energy security and industrial growth.
•Currently, information and communication regarding the project operations operate manually across multiple scattered platforms.

2. PROBLEM STATEMENT

- The project faces several key information accessibility challenges:
- **Inaccuracy:** Existing information online is often outdated or inconsistent due to irregular updates.
- **Scams and Misinformation:** Unofficial platforms display inaccurate project details or fraudulent contacts regarding employment and opportunities.
- **Lack of Transparency:** Details on environmental impact, employment opportunities, and development progress are scattered, making public verification difficult.

3. MAIN OBJECTIVE

- To design and develop an informative, user-friendly web platform that centralizes, updates, and streamlines public access to verified information regarding the Dangote East Africa Petroleum Refinery.
- **SPECIFIC OBJECTIVES**
- **Staff/Admin Access:** To allow system administrators to easily manage, update, and upload project data in real time.
- **Online/Public Information Reach:** To extend information reach to students, researchers, and the public across long distances with accurate status tracking.
- **Alert System:** To integrate an automated notification mechanism that alerts subscribers on news updates and announcement releases.

4. LITERATURE AND REVIEW

- **Remote Access:** Users can seamlessly access comprehensive information about the refinery from anywhere via an internet-connected device.
- **Performance & Efficiency:** Speeds up data dissemination and reduces time spent searching across multiple government and news portals.
- **User-Centric Design:** Built to handle high user demand with an intuitive layout accessible to both academic researchers and the general public.

5. GAP IN OTHER SYSTEMS

- Existing platforms providing information on major industrial projects include:
- **Government Portals (e.g., LAPSSET/SEZA):** Static document repositories; lack automated user notifications and interactive progress tracking.
- **News & Media Aggregators:** Offer fragmented articles; suffer from clutter, ads, and inconsistent updates without central record verification.
- **Corporate Directory Sites:** Lack detailed local impact assessments, responsive support channels, and direct inquiry capabilities.
- **Fix by Proposed System:** Centralizes verified refinery operational data and integrates dynamic web features with SMS/Email notifications for critical updates.

6. METHODOLOGY

- Data and functional requirements will be collected through:
- **Interviews:** Engaging key stakeholders, local community leaders, and industry researchers.
- **Observations:** Analyzing existing portal structures and user navigation patterns.
- **Questionnaires:** Distributing surveys to students and public users to identify primary information needs.

7. PROPOSED SYSTEM DESIGN

- **Users:** Admin, Staff (Content Managers), and General Users (Public/Researchers).
- **General Users:** Access the website to browse project specs, track development phases, and subscribe to updates.
- **Staff/Admin:** Manage articles, update project milestones, and monitor user inquiries.
- **Workflow:** User $\rightarrow$ Web Interface $\rightarrow$ Database $\rightarrow$ Admin (with Notification Alerts).

8. TOOLS AND TECHNOLOGIES

- **Frontend:** HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript.
- **Backend & Database:** PHP and MySQL for dynamic content and user inquiry management.
- **Alert Services:** Integration with an SMS gateway / Web Notification API for major announcement alerts.

9. PROJECT SCHEDULE

- Requirements Gathering & Analysis
- System & Interface Design
- Web Development & Database Integration
- System Testing & Error Correction
- Documentation & Final Presentation

10. REFERENCES

•Ministry of Foreign Affairs, Kenya. (2026). *President Ruto, Dangote launch East Africa Petroleum and Petrochemicals Zone in Lamu.*
•Ministry of Information, Communications and the Digital Economy. (2026). *Dangote refinery breakthrough marks major milestone for Kenya's industrialisation agenda.*
•Special Economic Zones Authority. (2026). *Groundbreaking ceremony of the Dangote East Africa Petroleum Refinery.*
•Web development and database design documentation from academic and industry portals.

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